ASCII MASTER FLOWCHART

Economic Impact of British Rule

20-panel revision companion | GS-I Modern Indian History

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 1/20: SCOPE AND GOVERNING PROPOSITION

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CENTRAL QUESTION: what did British rule DO to the Indian economy?
GOVERNING PROPOSITION:
  MODERNISATION OF CIRCULATION WITHOUT AUTONOMOUS DEVELOPMENT
        goods, information and people moved faster
        AND
        surplus direction, risk placement and policy control
        were located outside Indian hands
THREE IDEAS KEPT SEPARATE (never merged):
  COMPANY PLUNDER      episodic, conquest-linked extraction
  CONTINUING DRAIN     ongoing, institutional external transfer
  STRUCTURAL           the long-run outcome in land, craft,
  UNDERDEVELOPMENT     trade and industry
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 2/20: PERIODISATION BY DOMINANT MECHANISM

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c.1757-65 -> late 18th c.  TRIBUTE + TRADE MONOPOLY
        |                  (Diwani revenue provides the fiscal origin)
        v
1813 (Indian trade monopoly ends) / 1833 (China monopoly ends)
        |                  FREE-TRADE IMPERIALISM
        v                  asymmetric tariffs, machine imports
c.1850s -> 1940s           INTEGRATION WITHOUT AUTONOMY
                           railways, commercialisation,
                           guaranteed British capital
RULE: phases OVERLAP. They mark shifts of DOMINANCE, not
sealed eras. Revenue extraction did not stop in 1813.
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ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 3/20: THE PRE-COLONIAL BASELINE, STATED NARROWLY

```
CLAIMED: India was a leading exporter of
  cotton textiles | raw silk | indigo | saltpetre | opium
  sugar | rice | spices | precious stones
  supported by developed merchant capital and artisan
  production
NOT CLAIMED: universal prosperity, social equality, absence
  of poverty or famine, a pre-colonial industrial revolution
LOGICAL FUNCTION: a base that EXISTED can be ERODED
  => 'deindustrialisation' is correct
  => 'failure to industrialise' is a different claim
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 4/20: PERMANENT SETTLEMENT, 1793

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ARCHITECT Cornwallis | YEAR 1793 | REGION Bengal, Bihar, Orissa
UNIT the zamindari estate | REVISION fixed in PERPETUITY
        |
        v
STATE SIDE: absolute revenue certainty; no share in rising rents
ZAMINDAR SIDE: SUNSET LAW — miss the appointed date and the
        ESTATE ITSELF is sold
        |
        v
CONSEQUENCES: turnover of proprietors | absentee tendencies
        | layered rent-collecting intermediaries
BOUNDARY: 1793 fixed the STATE's claim on the ZAMINDAR,
        not the zamindar's RENT on the RYOT. Occupancy
        security was addressed only later and incompletely.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 5/20: RYOTWARI SETTLEMENT

```
ARCHITECTS Alexander Read, Thomas Munro
REGION largely Madras and Bombay presidencies
UNIT the individual ryot's holding | REVISION periodic, by survey
        |
        v
NO zamindar intermediary -> the RYOT is the state's debtor
        of record
        |
        v
CASH DEMAND ON A FIXED CALENDAR, REVISABLE
        -> bad season -> borrow -> mortgage -> LAND ALIENATION
        |
        v
TRAP: possession was CONDITIONAL ON PAYMENT.
Ryotwari did NOT create absolute, unconditional proprietorship
and is NOT automatically pro-peasant.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 6/20: MAHALWARI SETTLEMENT

```
FRAMEWORK Holt Mackenzie | IMPLEMENTATION R. M. Bird
REGION North-Western Provinces, later Punjab
UNIT the mahal (village or estate) | REVISION periodic
LIABILITY JOINT AND SEVERAL across co-sharers
        |
        +--> BUFFERS an individual co-sharer's bad year
        |
        +--> TRANSMITS a defaulter's burden to the rest
        |
        v
TRAP: Mahalwari was NOT permanent and did NOT restore
pre-colonial village autonomy. It was a colonial revenue
instrument using a village-level unit.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 7/20: THE THREE SETTLEMENTS COMPARED

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AXIS          PERMANENT      RYOTWARI       MAHALWARI
architect     Cornwallis     Read / Munro   Mackenzie / Bird
year/region   1793 Bengal,   Madras,        North-Western
              Bihar, Orissa  Bombay         Provinces, Punjab
unit          zamindari      individual     mahal
              estate         ryot holding
revision      perpetuity     periodic       periodic
intermediary  zamindar       none           village co-sharers
risk carrier  zamindar,      ryot           village body
              then tenant                   jointly
-----------------------------------------------------------------
COMMON CORE: a SECURE CASH DEMAND ON A FIXED CALENDAR
TWO COMPULSORY QUALIFIERS:
  (1) no system covered all India
  (2) all three were modified in practice by later law
      and revision
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 8/20: COMMERCIALISATION SHIFTED RISK DOWNWARD

```
CASH REVENUE DUE ON A FIXED DATE
        |
        +--> PLANTER / MERCHANT ADVANCE (crop pre-committed)
        +--> MONEYLENDER CREDIT (repayment pre-committed)
        |
        v
CASH CROPS: indigo, opium, cotton, jute, oilseeds,
            sugarcane, tea
        |
        v
PRICE FALL or HARVEST FAILURE
        -> claims stay FIXED, income does NOT
        -> INDEBTEDNESS -> MORTGAGE -> LAND ALIENATION
        -> former holder continues as tenant or wage labourer
QUALIFIER: some regions, crops and cultivators gained.
The charge is the DISTRIBUTION OF RISK, not blanket ruin.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 9/20: INDIGO, PABNA AND DECCAN ARE NOT ONE MOVEMENT

```
CASE        TARGET        RELATIONSHIP     REPERTOIRE
INDIGO      European      advance-based    COLLECTIVE
1859-60     planters      nij / ryoti      REFUSAL TO SOW
Bengal                    cultivation
PABNA       zamindars     rent enhancement LEAGUES,
from 1873                 beyond legal     RENT RESISTANCE,
E. Bengal                 limits           LITIGATION
DECCAN      moneylenders  debt and         SEIZURE AND
1875                      mortgage on      DESTRUCTION OF
Poona,                    written bonds    DEBT BONDS
Ahmadnagar
-----------------------------------------------------------------
EXAM RULE: match TARGET + RELATIONSHIP + REPERTOIRE before
comparing outcomes. Each repertoire is rational for its
adversary. BOUNDARY: economic-response cases here; fuller
wider political history is treated separately.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 10/20: DEINDUSTRIALISATION AS A CAUSAL WEB

```
MECHANISED BRITISH PRODUCTION ---> CAPACITY / lower unit cost
TARIFF AND MARKET ASYMMETRY ------> ACCESS to Indian markets
DECLINE OF COURT AND ELITE -------> DEMAND COLLAPSE for fine
  PATRONAGE                         high-value crafts
RAILWAY PENETRATION (1850s on) ---> DISTRIBUTION inland
        |
        v
RELATIVE DECLINE in craft OUTPUT / EMPLOYMENT / BARGAINING
POSITION — UNEVEN by REGION, CRAFT and PERIOD
        |
        v
NOT total extinction: coarse cloth and many village crafts
persisted. Deindustrialisation =/= failure to industrialise.
DRAIN is a DIFFERENT mechanism — do not fuse the two.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 11/20: THE 'HOW FAR' ANSWER ARCHITECTURE (2024 GS-I Q13)

```
STEP 1 CONCEDE THE NECESSARY CONDITION
       Industrial Revolution -> cheaper machine yarn and cloth
STEP 2 NAME THE TRANSMISSION MECHANISMS
       tariff asymmetry | colonial control of commercial policy
       court decline    | railway access to interior markets
STEP 3 APPLY THE COUNTERFACTUAL
       an economy with TARIFF AUTONOMY could have slowed,
       buffered or redirected the same technological shock
STEP 4 ADMIT THE VARIATION
       region, craft and period differ -> no extinction claim
STEP 5 GRADED VERDICT
       'substantially responsible, but not sufficient without
        colonial policy'   — NOT yes / no
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 12/20: DISPLACEMENT AND DE-URBANISATION ARE TWO CLAIMS

```
ARTISAN DISPLACEMENT            DE-URBANISATION
occupational structure          settlement pattern
craft demand falls              court and craft towns lose
 -> producers exit the craft     patron and trade
 -> PUSH TOWARD AGRICULTURE      -> population and function
 -> PRESSURE ON LAND:               contract
    sub-division, tenancy,       WHILE port and railway towns
    more dependants per holding  GROW
-----------------------------------------------------------------
SHARED CAUTION: both are REGIONALLY UNEVEN and the
contemporary series are thin. Argue qualitatively. Do NOT
invent a workforce share or a town population.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 13/20: DRAIN: NAME THE CHANNELS, NOT A TOTAL

```
INDIAN REVENUE AND EXPORT EARNINGS
   |      |         |          |            |
   v      v         v          v            v
HOME   OFFICIAL  INTEREST   STORES      IMPERIAL
CHARGES SALARIES + PROFIT   PURCHASED   MILITARY AND
+ India PENSIONS on British ABROAD ON   EXTERNAL
Office  PRIVATE  CAPITAL    INDIAN      EXPENDITURE
costs   REMIT-   incl.      ACCOUNT     charged to
        TANCES   GUARANTEED             Indian revenues
                 RETURNS
   |      |         |          |            |
   +------+----+----+----------+------------+
                 v
   OBLIGATION DISCHARGED IN BRITAIN, NO EQUIVALENT
   INWARD ECONOMIC RETURN TO INDIA
                 |
                 v
RULE: transfer concept, not trade concept. State the channels.
DO NOT invent a total, an annual figure or a percentage.
Internal taxation spent inside India is NOT drain.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 14/20: THE NATIONALIST ECONOMIC CRITIQUE

```
DADABHAI NAOROJI   'Poverty and Un-British Rule in India'
                   -> DRAIN as the mechanism of poverty
R. C. DUTT         'The Economic History of India'
                   -> LAND REVENUE and agrarian pressure
                      reconstructed from OFFICIAL RECORD
M. G. RANADE       -> INDUSTRIAL DEVELOPMENT and a
                      constructive state role; poverty as a
                      PRODUCTION-STRUCTURE problem
-----------------------------------------------------------------
COMBINED EFFECT: poverty relocated from CLIMATE AND CUSTOM
to POLICY AND INSTITUTIONS.
TRAP: do NOT swap the two book titles between Naoroji and Dutt.
SCOPE: organised political deployment is treated separately.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 15/20: EXPORT SURPLUS AND COUNCIL BILLS

```
INDIA EXPORTS MORE (visible) THAN IT IMPORTS
        -> a RECORDED merchandise export surplus
                |
        COUNCIL BILLS sold in LONDON for sterling
                |
        bill presented in INDIA, paid from RUPEE FUNDS
                |
        sterling applied to HOME CHARGES and other
        EXTERNAL OBLIGATIONS
                |
                v
ANALYTICAL POINT: the surplus SETTLED CLAIMS ABROAD instead
of returning as imports or investment. A surplus need not
mean resources remained available in India.
BARRED FACT: no adopted rupee-sterling ratio is stated here.
1s 4d belongs ONLY to Gandhi's 1930 eleven-point demand; the
Hilton-Young adopted rate is treated as UNVERIFIED.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 16/20: INFRASTRUCTURE, GUARANTEE SYSTEM AND FORESTS

```
DESIGN PURPOSE                UNINTENDED CONSEQUENCE
troop movement, internal  |   market integration
 security                 |   labour and pilgrim mobility
administrative control    |   relief movement where policy
raw-material evacuation   |    permitted
import distribution       |   later: nationalist travel,
                          |    press, organisation
-----------------------------------------------------------------
FINANCING — THE GUARANTEE SYSTEM
  private British capital <- ASSURED MINIMUM RETURN
  shortfall met from INDIAN REVENUES
  => risk socialised in India, return secured in Britain
-----------------------------------------------------------------
FOREST ADMINISTRATION (infrastructure of extraction)
  1806 oak and teak reserved for the Navy
  1864 Forest Department
  1865 Government Forests Act
  1878 Indian Forest Act -> RESERVED / PROTECTED /
       UNCLASSIFIED categories
  -> customary use curtailed -> tribal resistance
SAFE VERDICT: modern infrastructure WITHOUT autonomous
developmental priority.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 17/20: COLONIAL INDUSTRIALISATION: REAL BUT CONSTRAINED

```
WHAT GREW                     WHAT CONSTRAINED IT
plantations (tea, coffee)  |   access to long-term finance
jute manufacture           |   tariff and procurement bias
cotton textile mills       |   imported capital goods and
coal and other mining      |    technology dependence
later iron and steel       |   narrow domestic purchasing
CONTROL: foreign capital |    power
and managing agencies      |   no protective policy under
powerful in key sectors    |    Indian control
-----------------------------------------------------------------
RECONCILIATION: craft decline AND modern-sector growth are
COMPATIBLE — different products, places and labour markets,
so the new sector never absorbed the displaced.
VERDICT: industry developed UNEVENLY; deindustrialisation
never meant zero industry.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 18/20: FAMINE: TRIGGER SEPARATED FROM AMPLIFIERS

```
        CLIMATIC SHOCK (drought / monsoon failure) = TRIGGER
                          |
   +----------+---------+---------+-----------+
   v          v                   v           v
REVENUE   COMMERCIAL-        TRANSPORT     RELIEF DOCTRINE
RIGIDITY  ISATION            FOLLOWS       work tests, cost
cash due  cash crops and     PRICE not     ceilings, late
on a      credit replace     NEED; grain   official
fixed     food buffers       leaves a      declaration
calendar                     district that
                             cannot bid
   +----------+---------+---------+-----------+
                          v  = AMPLIFIERS
              ENTITLEMENT FAILURE
   people cannot COMMAND food even where food EXISTS
                          |
                          v
REJECT the climate-only explanation AND the export-only
explanation. ASSERT NO MORTALITY FIGURE — contemporary
estimates vary widely and are disputed.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 19/20: FAMINE SEQUENCE, POLICY AND VARIATION

```
1770  BENGAL FAMINE — early-Company period; BOUNDED BRIDGE
19th c. RECURRENT REGIONAL FAMINES under settled revenue
1876-78 GREAT SOUTHERN / DECCAN FAMINE — severe, multi-province
1880  STRACHEY (FAMINE) COMMISSION -> relief principles
      codified -> Famine Code framework
1896-1900 RENEWED SEVERE FAMINES
1901  R. C. Dutt's economic-history reconstruction published
1943  BENGAL FAMINE — used only as a bounded bridge
-----------------------------------------------------------------
EXAMINABLE PIVOT: if relief was codified in 1880, why did
severe famine recur? -> tests the DOCTRINE, not the chronology.
-----------------------------------------------------------------
VARIATION AXES: region (irrigated vs dry) | tenure (secure vs
tenancy-at-will vs sharecropping) | caste access to credit,
land and commons | gender entitlement | ecology (forest and
pastoral users under the 1865/1878 Acts).
DISCIPLINE: aggregates conceal distribution.
```

ASCII MASTER FLOW — PANEL 20/20: HISTORIOGRAPHY, BARRED FACTS, PYQ ROUTES, ANSWER SPINE

```
HISTORIOGRAPHY
  NATIONALIST (Naoroji, Dutt) drain + deindustrialisation
  MARXIST / STRUCTURAL        dependent integration into
                              world capitalism
  REVISIONIST (Morris D.      disputes SCALE and
  Morris, Daniel Thorner)     MEASURABILITY, not all
                              structural change
  REGIONAL                    outcomes varied by place,
                              sector and social group
  SYNTHESIS: extraction AND transformation, assessed together
-----------------------------------------------------------------
BARRED / UNVERIFIED — NEVER ASSERT
  any drain total, annual figure or percentage
  any famine mortality figure
  the adopted Hilton-Young rupee-sterling rate
  (1s 4d = Gandhi's 1930 eleven-point demand ONLY)
  any craft-employment share or town population
-----------------------------------------------------------------
PYQ ROUTES
  SOLVED: 2022 GS-I Q3 (famine spurt, 10m/150w)
          2024 GS-I Q13 (Industrial Revolution and
                         handicrafts, Discuss, 15m/250w)
  UNSOLVED OBJECTIVE DEMANDS: 2018 Prelims Q52, Q68;
          2020 Prelims Q23, Q33
  2024 Prelims Q57 OFFICIALLY DROPPED — demand-control only
  2026 Prelims Q2 key PROVISIONAL — no answer inferred
  ADJACENT: 2018 Prelims Q51; 2018 GS-I Q13 (indentured
            labour) — bounded bridges only
-----------------------------------------------------------------
ANSWER SPINE FOR ANY FULL-TOPIC QUESTION
  1 revenue and property redesign
  2 commercialisation and credit risk
  3 craft decline  <-->  drain (two different mechanisms)
  4 infrastructure and dependent industry
  5 famine vulnerability
  6 regional and social variation
  7 attributed historiography and a qualified verdict
```